By **RAGHUNATH MASHELKAR**

Scientist, innovator and technocrat



Proof of Eminence

Indian scientists and innovators have had numerous achievements in the past 75 years that have made us all proud. If the Green and White Revolutions ensured food security for the nation, its nuclear, space and defence research has placed India among the global leaders. Here, we select the key milestones that have been game-changers for India



NAMAS BHOJANI

Exploration Geologists

Fuelling India's early oil exploration

It is not widely known that every hydrocarbon molecule in India's oil reserves has been discovered by Indian exploration geologists. North Sea oil and offshore Bombay High oil and gas were discovered almost simultaneously. But India beat the UK in bringing the production to its peak earlier. This was achieved by the technologists of the Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) under the leadership of its visionary chairman Bhanu Prasad. Mumbai High and Bassein are today India's top oil- and gas-producing fields, accounting for almost two-thirds of the country's total production.